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Program or Project has component (if no, proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation	
Municipality/City:	Cuartero
Province:	Capiz
Region:	VI
(5) Classification Research: ☒ Basic Development: ☐ Pilot Testing	(6) Mode of Implementation ☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☒ Collaborative Research (within the center)

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☐ Applied ☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	☒ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☒ Collaborative Research (external agency)
(7) Sector/Commodity Governance and Policy	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Strategic Planning and Public Policy

(9A) Abstract

This descriptive survey study used the Citizen Satisfaction Index System to appraise the local government service delivery comparative results, satisfaction, the need for action across seven (7) service areas, and the citizen's general attitude towards the LGU. The multi-stage probability sampling covers respondents who qualified in the inclusion criteria. Results revealed a high level of satisfaction in all service areas. However, the residents need to avail themselves of the services offered, particularly in economic and investment promotion. There is a high satisfaction and a low need for action regarding education, governance, and the environment. Service areas such as health, social welfare, public works and infrastructure, and economic and investment promotion resulted in continued emphasis. There is a need to sustain positive aspects of services. Moreover, fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved. The citizens have a positive attitude towards the local government unit of Cuartero.

(9B) Keywords

Citizen Satisfaction Index System, general attitude, need for action, satisfaction, service areas

(10) Introduction

The Citizen Satisfaction Index System (CSIS) is a set of data tools designed to collect and generate relevant citizens' feedback on the local government's service delivery performance and the citizens' general satisfaction. DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2012-113 promulgated the implementation of the CSIS.

The CSIS is a client/citizen perception-based performance assessment that measures the respondent's satisfaction with public services. To contextualize satisfaction data, the analysis involves several steps covering the concepts of awareness, availment, satisfaction, and need for action (CSIS Manual, 2021). The DILG Memorandum Circular No. 2021-003 pertains to the Policies and General Guidelines for implementing the Citizen Satisfaction Index System. The CSIS will cover identified local government units as recipients of the Seal of Good Local Governance. The Municipality of Cuartero is the only municipality in the Province of Capiz qualified for the criteria.

The concerned parties in implementing CSIS are the Bureau of Local Government Supervision (BLGS), the DILG Regional Office, and the Local Resource Institute (LRI). In the case of the Municipality of Cuartero, Capiz State University served as the LRI. The LRI, as an academic institution, provides training, learning, and extension services in the communities. Data generated may serve as baseline data to guide the Local Government Unit to improve its delivery of essential services to the citizens.

This study aimed to appraise the local government service delivery of basic services as to satisfaction and need for action, comparative results per service area, and citizen's general attitude towards local government unit.

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(11) Methodology

Research Design

The study used a descriptive survey design to appraise the satisfaction and need for action across seven (7) service areas of the local government unit, the comparative results per service area, and the citizen's general attitude towards the local government unit.

Duration and Location of the Study

This study was conducted in all 22 barangays of the Municipality of Cuartero, Capiz. Sample barangays were generated using sampling with probability proportional to size.

Respondents of the Study

There is an equal participation of male and female respondents in the study. Seventy-five respondents, both male and female, were considered. The multi-stage probability sampling was used to ensure that every citizen, 18 years old and above, male or female, who has lived at least six months in the LGU is given an equal chance to be selected as a participant in the study with no preference for any particular socio-demographic characteristic, political/ideological orientation or religious belief.

Data Gathering Procedure

The researchers sought permission from the municipal mayor in coordination with the Department of the Interior and Local Government. Courtesy visits and ocular inspections in the barangays were done. The respondents signed an informed consent form to ensure ethical standards. The questionnaire on the Citizen Satisfaction Index System of the DILG was utilized. The spot map, Kish grid, and call sheets were also used to guide the field interviewers during data collection.

Data Analysis

Gathered data were analyzed using descriptive statistics such as frequency counts and percentages.

(12) Results and Discussions

Comparative Results per Service Area

Table 1 presents the comparative results in all service areas regarding satisfaction and need for action. Of the 150 respondents, 130 (87.25%) were satisfied with the health services offered by the municipality while 19 (12.75%) were not. Ninety-two (61.74%) agreed on the need for action on the health services/programs, while 57 (38.26%) did not feel the need for appropriate action.

The overall service area assessment to support to education of the local government showed that the number of respondents who are satisfied (125 or 91.24%) are higher than those who are not satisfied (12 or 8.76%). Most of the respondents (79 or 57.66%) believed there is no need for action in this area than those who felt otherwise (58 or 42.34%).

Of the 150 respondents, 131 (89.73%) are satisfied with the social welfare service program, while 15 (10.27%) are not satisfied. As to the need for action, 78 (53.42%) felt that there was a need to do so, while 68 (46.58%) believed otherwise. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating. Likewise, a high need for

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action is suggested by the need for action rating.

Of the 150 respondents, 135 (93.10%) are satisfied with the services on governance and response, while 10 (6.90%) are not satisfied. As to need for action, 72 (49.66%) agreed that it is needed while 73 (50.34%) believed otherwise. Five respondents were unaware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating. However, the overall need for action score still suggests a high need for action to be taken.

The overall service assessment rating revealed that more (119 or 80.41%) respondents were satisfied than those who believed otherwise (29 or 19.59%) as to the public works and infrastructure services. Out of 148 respondents, 97 (65.54%) felt that there was a need for action while 51 (36.46%) thought otherwise. Two respondents were not aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high rating. While satisfaction is high, the overall need for action is still high.

The respondents are satisfied (115, 84.56%) with the local government's efforts in terms of environmental management. They believe that a need for action (99, 72.79%) in this service area should be taken. Sixteen respondents were not aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score is high. However, the need for action rating is likewise high.

One hundred seven (75.89%) of the respondents are satisfied with the local government's economic and investment promotion programs and services, while 34 (24.11%) are not satisfied. Data revealed further that 93 (65.96%) of the respondents said that these economic and investment promotion programs or services need appropriate action from the local government while 48 (34.04%) felt otherwise. Nine respondents were unaware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating from the people of Cuartero.

The overall percentage score suggests a high satisfaction and high need for appropriate action ratings from local government people. This implies a continued emphasis on sustaining the positive aspects of the services cited by citizens. Fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved.

Citizen's Satisfaction Rating

Table 2 presents the comparative results in all service areas regarding satisfaction. Of the 150 respondents, 130 (87.25%) were satisfied with the health services offered by the municipality, while 19 (12.75%) were not.

The overall service area assessment to support the education of the local government showed that the number of respondents who are satisfied (125 or 91.24%) is higher than those who are not satisfied (12 or 8.76%).

Of the 150 respondents, 131 (89.73%) are satisfied with the social welfare service program, while 15 (10.27%) are not satisfied. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating.

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Of the 150 respondents, 135 (93.10%) are satisfied with the services on governance and response, while 10 (6.90%) are not satisfied. Five respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating.

The overall service assessment rating revealed that more (119 or 80.41%) respondents were satisfied than those who believed otherwise (29 or 19.59%) regarding public works and infrastructure services. Two respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high rating.

The respondents are satisfied (115, 84.56%) with the local government's efforts in terms of environmental management. Sixteen respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked. The overall satisfaction percentage score is high.

One hundred seven (75.89%) of the respondents are satisfied with the local government's economic and investment promotion programs and services, while 34 (24.11%) are not satisfied. Nine respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall satisfaction percentage score suggests a high satisfaction rating from the people of Cuartero.

Governance and response got the highest satisfaction rating (93.10%), while the lowest is on economic and investment promotion (75.89%).

The study by Gabinete et al. (2022) cited that citizens viewed health services as the most prominent (Yecla and Ortega, 2020), but this is in contrast to another study that reported otherwise (Torreno, 2017). It must be noted that most of the projects in the Philippines came with a meager budget. With a limited budget comes fragmented programs that will hardly reach the significant number of rural farmers in our study sites; hence, the local government needs more awareness of agricultural facilities and farming-related programs. According to Gabinete et al. (2022), using the CSIS survey tool in Lambunao, Iloilo, the Philippines, on seven local government unit service areas revealed a high awareness rating (81%), especially on health services.

Citizen's Need for Action Rating

Table 3 presents the comparative results in all service areas regarding need for action. Ninety-two (61.74%) agreed on the need for action on the health services/programs, while 57 (38.26%) did not feel the need for appropriate action.

The overall service area assessment to support to education of the local government showed that most of the respondents (79 or 57.66%) believed there is no need for action in this area than those who felt otherwise (58 or 42.34%).

Regarding the need for action on social welfare service programs, 78 (53.42%) felt that there is a need to do so, while 68 (46.58%) believed otherwise. The need for action rating suggests a high need for action.

On governance and response, 72 (49.66%) agreed that there is a need for action, while 73 (50.34%) believed otherwise. The overall need for action score still suggests a high need for action to be taken.

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The overall service assessment rating for public works and infrastructure revealed that out of 148 respondents, 97 (65.54%) believed there was a need for action, while 51 (36.46%) thought otherwise. Two respondents were not aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The overall need for action is high.

The respondents believed that there was a need for action (99, 72.79%) with the local government's efforts in terms of environmental management. Sixteen respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked to them. The need for action rating is high.

The local government's economic and investment promotion programs and services data revealed further that 93 (65.96%) of the respondents said these economic and investment promotion programs or services need appropriate action from the local government. In comparison, 48 (34.04%) felt otherwise. Nine respondents needed to be made aware of any program, so the overall questions were not asked.

Environmental management obtained the highest need for action (72.79%), while governance and response (49.66%) are the least.

Poor service delivery may affect the citizens' perception (Susanto & Goodwin, 2010). Failure of the government to offer quality services will develop into public distrust, while highly acceptable and well-planned programs and services will raise trust in the government. Ninety-five percent of the citizens clamored for more actions, mainly for public works and infrastructure (Gabinete et al., 2022). Ranking of services according to overall satisfaction is in this order: health services > support to education > social welfare > environmental management > governance and response > economic and investment promotion > public works and infrastructure (Gabinete et al., 2022).

Citizen's Overall Satisfaction and Need for Action

Generally, the majority (127 or 84.67%) of the people in Cuartero are satisfied with the overall services given to them by the local government. Only 23 (15.33%) are unsatisfied (Figure 1). Despite their high trust and satisfaction, 100 (66.67%) of them suggest that the local programs or services offered need appropriate action from the local government to improve these services. Fifty (33.33%) of the respondents believed there was no need for appropriate action (Figure 2). Most of the citizens (110 or 73.33%) believed that their status of life improved in the past year, 36 (24%) could not say if it improved or worsened, and four (2.67%) claimed it worsened (Figure 3).

The percentage score obtained suggests a high satisfaction rating from local government people. The percentage score obtained suggests a high overall need for action rating. This implies a continued emphasis on sustaining the positive aspects of the services cited by citizens. Fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved.

In the case of Gabinete et al. (2022), citizens clamored for more action on the social welfare aspects. The government must therefore identify the constituents' needs and design policies to address these issues in the hope of attaining more responsive social welfare development. In the present study, however, environmental management had the highest need for action.

Figure 4 presents the overall action grid of all service areas. The following service areas are found to have high satisfaction and low need for action: support to education, governance and response, and environmental management. This implies that These service areas

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exceeded the expectations of the citizens. As cited by the citizens, positive aspects of the services have to be sustained. There is a need to evaluate if other resource commitments can be refocused.

Service areas such as health, social welfare, public works and infrastructure, and economic and investment promotion resulted in continued emphasis. This means that there is a need to sustain positive aspects of services as cited by the citizens. Moreover, fine-tune specific aspects of service delivery that can still be improved. The respondent's satisfaction may also be due to high expectations of the services. If met, higher expectations may contribute to satisfaction with the rated services (Gabinete, 2022).

Citizen's General Attitude Towards Local Government Unit

Most respondents (131 out of 150 or 87.33%) agreed that they declare their complaints about the local government and its officials without being afraid for their safety (See Table 5). One hundred forty (93.33%) agreed that something good will come if they present local problems or issues to authorities. They (139 or 92.67%) believe that any problem will be solved by the authorities in our locality. The respondents greatly benefit from the services provided by the Municipality of Cuartero (135 or 90%). The rich or poor citizens in Cuartero have fair access to services from the local government (122 or 81.33%). Taxes and fees collected by the local government fairly reflect the quality of local programs and services it provides (140 or 93.33%).

The respondents (145 or 96.67%) believed that Cuartero is doing its part in becoming a peaceful, disaster-resilient Cuartero, a convergence for socio-economic and local tourism in Capiz, with dynamic local government and empowered people living in a safe and progressive environment. Also, it commits to enriching and upholding the Cuartero way of life, pursuing socio-economic development, ensuring responsive delivery of basic services, and attaining a better quality of life (143 or 95.33%). They will recommend to friends from other localities to transfer their residence to Cuartero (139 or 92.67%). With their high level of trust in their local government, almost all (146 out 150 or 97.33%) are proud to say they are residents of Cuartero, Capiz.

Table 6 discloses the respondents' general attitude towards staying or leaving the municipality in the next five years. Of the 150 respondents, 137 (91.33%) affirmed that they wanted to stay, while 13 (8.67%) wanted to transfer. Those who wanted to stay primarily cited that they value their hometown by spending the rest of their lives in the municipality and that their life has been entirely spent with their families and the community. Those who wanted to transfer presented work-related reasons for their decision.

The primary reasons of the respondents to stay in the municipality is shown in Table 7. These primary reasons are: I have my livelihood here (44 or 32.12%), I grew up here (19 or 13.87%), We are happy and contented (14 or 10.22%), Not applicable (12 or 8.76%), This is a beautiful and peaceful place (11 or 8.03%), I have no plans to leave (10 or 7.30%), We have properties here (9 or 6.57%), and I grew up and will die here (5 or 3.65%).

Table 8 presents the respondents' primary reasons for leaving the municipality in the next five years. The respondents identified these reasons: looking for a job (4 or 2.92%), proximity to medical facilities (2 or 1.46%), being with children who are still studying (2 or 1.46%), for a better environment (1 or 0.73%), migration (1 or 0.73%), no livelihood in the community (1 or 0.73%), no house ownership (1 or 0.73%), and no lot ownership (1 or 0.73%).

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(13) Conclusions and Recommendations

Conclusions

There is a high level of satisfaction in all service areas. However, the people in the Municipality of Cuartero need to better avail themselves of the services offered by the local government, particularly in economic and investment promotion.

Consistent citizens' satisfaction in the various service areas entails the local government unit delivering the goods and services.

With the high satisfaction and need for action, the quality of service delivery may be good, but there is still a need to tune specific aspects further to sustain the current service and/or exceed the citizens' expectations.

The citizens have a positive attitude towards the local government unit of Cuartero. This can be attested to the preference to stay in the municipality since they value their hometown.

Recommendations

Develop effective mechanisms to widely disseminate the services the local government offers in all communication platforms to bring informed choices, especially to citizens residing outside the town proper.

Proper coordination between key persons at the municipal and barangay levels may be observed to ensure the continuous equitable availment of all the services offered by the local government, proper coordination between key persons at the municipal and barangay levels may be observed. Information sharing may be kept open. Regular and participatory monitoring at the ground level may be done. Top-down and bottom-up approaches to community engagement can be utilized.

Continuous monitoring, evaluation, and replanning may be done to maintain and/or further improve the municipality's performance in all service areas.

The exemplary practices of the local government should be maintained. Areas needing improvement may be properly identified for the formulation of solutions that might effectively address the emerging problems.

(14) Output

Focus Group Discussion with the Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) – Click the link below:
<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JT77zFwBbUsjBk7LfYAp333Y-P13XNCh/view?usp=sharing>

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted

(17) Acknowledgments

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Appendices

Table 1. Comparative results in all service areas in terms of satisfaction.

Service Area	Satisfaction		Need for Action	
Health	87.25	High	61.74	High
Support to Education	91.24	High	42.34	Low
Social Welfare	89.73	High	53.42	High
Governance and Response	93.10	High	49.66	Low
Public Works and Infrastructure	80.41	High	65.54	High
Environmental Management	91.04	High	42.54	Low
Economic and Investment Promotion	75.89	High	65.96	High
OVERALL	84.67	High	66.67	High

Table 2. Comparative results in all service areas in terms of satisfaction.

Service Area	Satisfied		Not Satisfied	
	f	%	f	%
Health	130	87.25	19	12.75
Support to Education	125	91.24	12	8.76
Social Welfare	131	89.73	15	10.27
Governance and Response	135	93.10	10	6.90
Public Works and Infrastructure	119	80.41	29	19.59
Environmental Management	115	84.56	35	15.44
Economic and Investment Promotion	107	75.89	43	24.11

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Table 3. Comparative results in all service areas in terms of need for action.

Service Area	Need for Action		No Need for Action	
	f	%	f	%
Health	92	61.74	57	38.26
Support to Education	79	57.66	58	42.34
Social Welfare	78	53.42	68	46.58
Governance and Response	72	49.66	73	50.34
Public Works and Infrastructure	97	65.54	51	36.46
Environmental Management	99	72.79	*	*
Economic and Investment Promotion	93	65.96	48	34.04

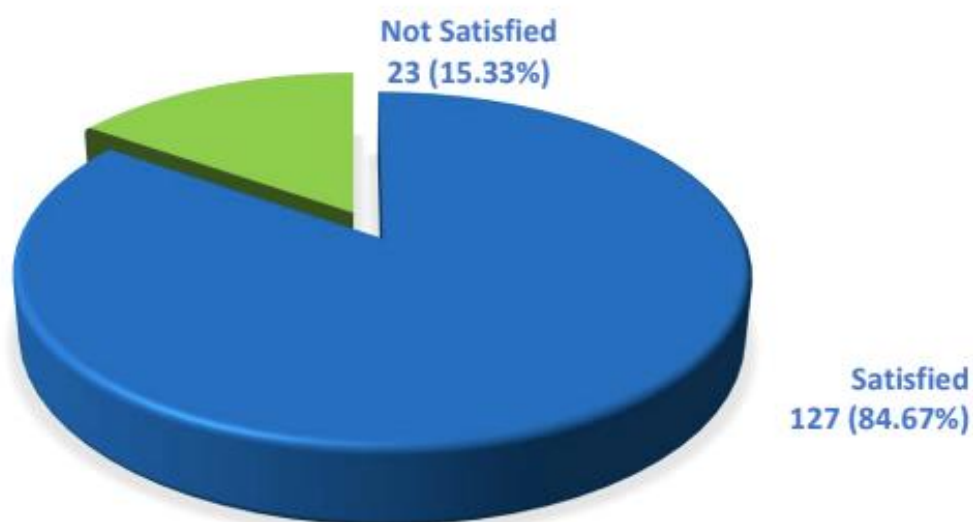


Figure 1. Overall satisfaction rating

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Figure 2. Overall need for action rating

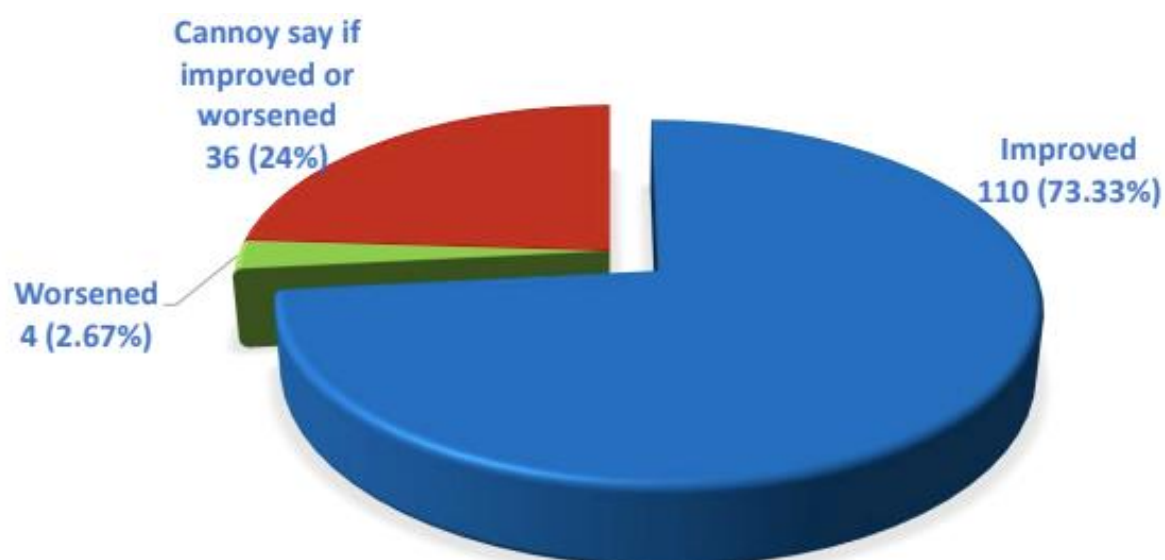


Figure 3. Overall perception in the status of life in the past year

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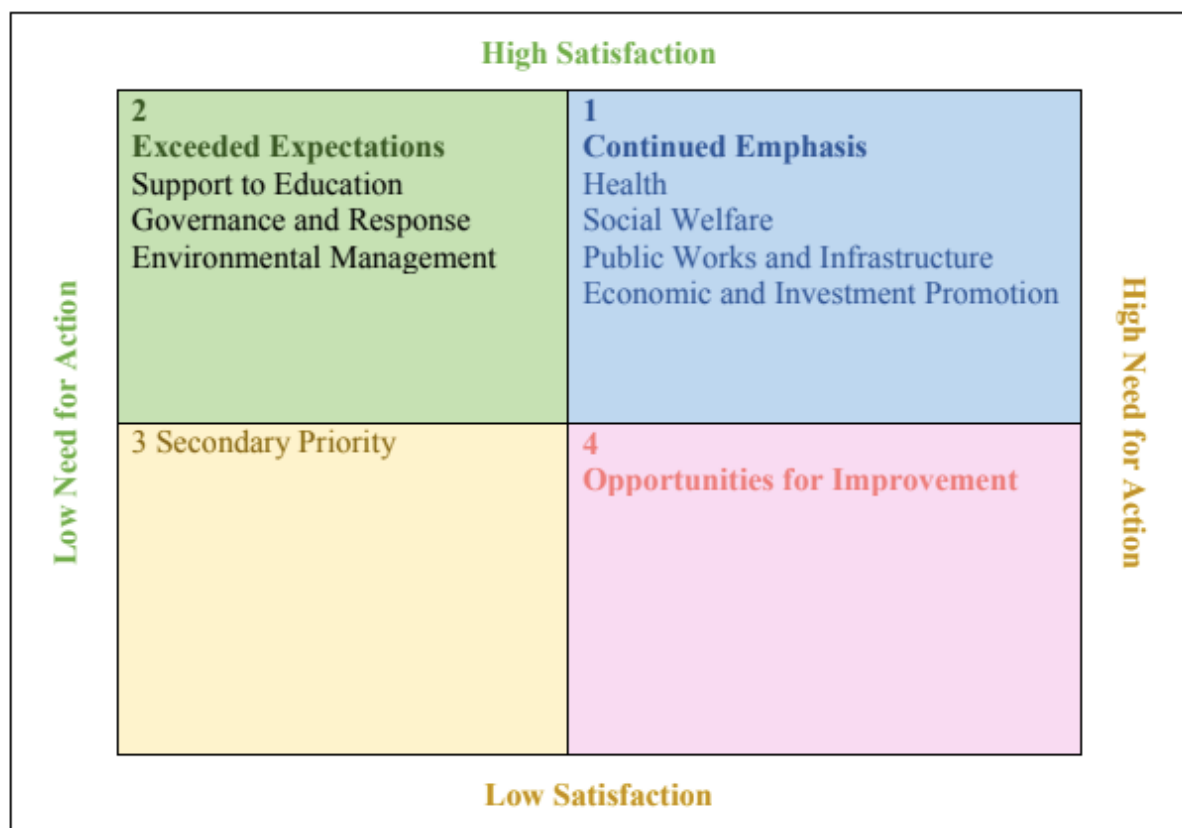


Figure 4. Overall action grid showing the service areas

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Table 5. Citizen's general attitude towards the local government unit.

Items	Agree		Disagree	
	f	%	f	%
I can declare my complaints about the local government and its officials without being afraid for my safety.	131	87.33	19	12.67
Something good will come out of presenting local problems and issues to authorities.	140	93.33	10	6.67
I believe that any problem will be solved by the authorities in our locality.	139	92.67	11	7.33
I greatly benefit from the services provided by our local government.	135	90	15	10
Rich or poor citizens in our place have fair access to services from the local government.	122	81.33	28	18.67
Taxes and fees collected by the local government fairly reflect the quality of local programs and services it provides.	140	93.33	10	6.67
The Municipality of Cuartero is doing its part towards the direction of its vision: A peaceful, disaster-resilient Cuartero, a convergence for socio-economic and local tourism in Capiz, with dynamic local government and empowered people living in a safe and progressive environment.	145	96.67	5	3.33
The Municipality of Cuartero is doing its part to fulfill its mission: We commit to enrich and uphold the Cuartero way of life, pursue socio-economic development, ensure responsive delivery of basic services and attain a better quality of life.	143	95.33	7	4.67
I will recommend to friends from other localities to transfer their residence to our place.	139	92.67	11	7.33
I am proud to say that I am a resident of Cuartero, Capiz.	146	97.33	4	2.67

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Table 6. Citizen's attitude towards staying or leaving the municipality in the next five years.

Attitude Towards Staying or Leaving the Municipality in the Next Five Years	Total Number of Responses	Percent (%)
Stay	137	91.33
Transfer	13	8.67
TOTAL	150	100.00

Table 7. Citizen's reasons of staying in the municipality in the next five years.

Reasons of Staying in the Municipality in the Next Five Years	Total Number of Responses	Percent (%)
I have my livelihood here.	44	32.12
I grew up here.	19	13.87
We are happy and contented.	14	10.22
My family is here.	13	9.49
Not applicable	12	8.76
This is a beautiful and peaceful place.	11	8.03
I have no plans to leave.	10	7.30
We have properties here.	9	6.57
I grew up and will die here.	5	3.65
TOTAL	137	100.00

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Table 8. Citizen's reasons of leaving the municipality in the next five years.

Reasons of Leaving the Municipality in the Next Five Years	Total Number of Responses	Percent (%)
Look for a job	4	2.92
Proximity to medical facilities	2	1.46
To be with children who are still studying	2	1.46
For a better environment	1	0.73
Migration	1	0.73
No livelihood in the community	1	0.73
No house ownership	1	0.73
No lot ownership	1	0.73
TOTAL	13	100.00